RACHEL OKONKWO

Director, Developer Experience and InnerSource | AI Platforms, Contribution Models, Engineering Enablement

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SUMMARY

Engineering enablement leader with 16 years across software engineering, developer relations, and developer experience, the last 7 in financial services. I lead a 22 person developer experience and InnerSource function serving 3,100 engineers and data scientists at a regulated insurer and asset manager, where I built the internal reuse program for AI assets, its governance, and the community around it. Known for making contribution easy and visible: clear ownership, light review paths, and recognition that shows up in performance reviews.

CORE SKILLS

Platform and InnerSource: contribution workflows, CODEOWNERS and maintainer models, quality tiers, release practices, internal developer portals (Backstage), documentation standards, sandbox environments.

AI engineering: agent frameworks, reusable agent skills, prompt libraries and versioning, retrieval patterns, evaluation harnesses, model risk controls.

Leadership: org design, hiring managers, budget ownership, executive sponsorship, HR and talent partnership, adoption metrics.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Calder Mutual Financial (insurance and asset management, 18,000 employees) | Charlotte, NC

Director, Developer Experience and InnerSource | 2022 to Present

Lead 3 managers and 22 engineers, product managers, and community staff; $4.8M annual budget; serve 3,100 engineers and data scientists across 9 business units.

Launched the InnerSource program for AI assets, including GitHub Enterprise contribution workflows, ownership rules, and three quality tiers; the catalog grew to 260 reusable components, agent skills, prompts, and evaluation patterns in two years.

Stood up an AI sandbox with masked production data, cutting average time from idea to working prototype from 4 weeks to 6 days.

Built an intake triage assistant that routes new AI requests to existing assets and their maintainers; 44 percent of 700 requests were met by reuse instead of new builds.

Grew the contributor community from 30 to 410 through office hours, monthly demo days, three working groups, and a contributor onboarding course.

Worked with HR to add contribution and maintenance to engineering career ladders, and with model risk to shorten review for tiered assets from 7 weeks to 8 days.

Report adoption, reuse rate, duplicate builds avoided (31 in 2025), and contributor health to the CIO quarterly.

Senior Manager, Developer Productivity | 2019 to 2022

Led a team of 9; $1.6M budget.

Rolled out Backstage as the internal developer portal, reaching 85 percent of active services within 18 months.

Created golden-path templates that cut new service setup from 3 days to under 2 hours.

Fernway Software (developer tools) | Raleigh, NC

Manager, Developer Relations | 2015 to 2019

Led a team of 5 advocates; $900K program budget.

Grew the developer community from 8,000 to 41,000 members and launched a contributor program that brought in 300 external pull requests a year.

Ran the open-source maintainer program for 12 SDK repositories, including code review norms, release cadence, and contributor recognition.

EARLIER CAREER

Software Engineer, Brookline Analytics (2010 to 2015). QA Engineer, Datacove (2008 to 2010).

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Computer Engineering, Georgia Institute of Technology. AWS Certified Solutions Architect, Associate. InnerSource Commons Fundamentals.